

loopholes often being misused for cross-border dumping

6. Formulate and regulate occupational health safety norms for e-waste recycling, which is now mainly confined to the informal sector

7. Promulgate an all-embracing natural e-waste management law

8. Create a public-private participation forum for decision making and problem solving in e-waste management

9. Create a database of best global practices and failure analysis for development and deployment of efficacious e-waste management and disposal practices

Role of industries. The safest and the least expensive solution to the e-waste problem is to avoid creating it in the first place. Proper control over materials used in the production process is an important way to reduce waste generation. In addition to this:

1. Equipment components must be clearly labeled to identify plastic and metal types, which would help to segregate them at the end-of-lifecycle of the product.

2. Hazardous materials used during product formulation or production process may be replaced with a less hazardous or non-hazardous material.

3. As most of the materials used are non-renewable, design engineers should ensure that the product is built for reuse, repair and/or upgradeability.

4. Labeling of all components of the equipment for detection of hazardous material contents should be strictly enforced with a view to identifying environmental hazards and ensuring proper material management and e-waste disposal.

Responsibility of the society.

The society has a major role to play in handling the e-waste menace. The

buyers may opt for those electrical or electronic products that are 'green,' use recycled components, are energy-efficient and upgradeable, come with take-back option and have been certified by the governing or regulatory authority.

Apart from these initiatives, reuse of the electronic products is a preferable alternative to recycling the discarded products. Used workable electronic products such as calculators, computers, keyboards, network communication devices and audio/video equipment can be donated to recognised non-commercial educational institutions, registered charitable hospitals and public libraries for the benefit of lower-income families. ●

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